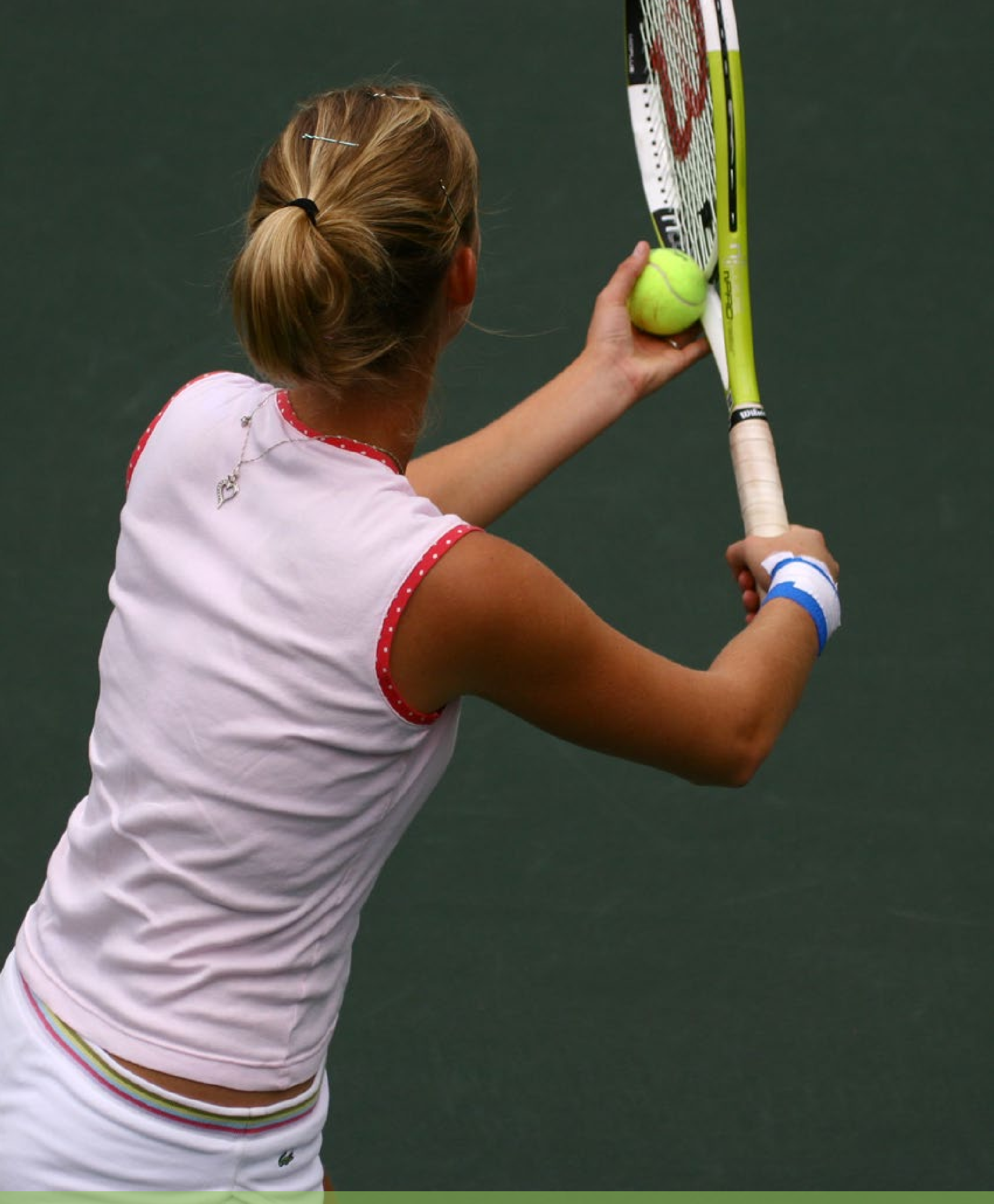
City of Abbotsford

SPORT FIELD & SPORT COURT STRATEGY

Draft - February 2026

rcs+

ABBOTSFORD



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1. Introduction

1.1. Strategy Background and Purpose

The City of Abbotsford has developed this Sport Field and Sport Court Strategy to guide how the City will invest in and provide these important and valued assets over the next 20+ years. More specifically, the Strategy presented an opportunity to:

- Revisit priorities and recommendations identified in previous planning (including the City's 2018 Parks, Recreation & Culture Master Plan);
- Identify focus areas and priorities for capital investment into existing and new infrastructure; and
- Suggest improvements to how the inventory is managed and leveraged for public benefit.

The Strategy will be used by City Council and administration as a resource to guide future budgeting and decision making.

Outdoor Sport Facilities Included in this Strategy:

- Sport fields
- Ball diamonds
- Games courts
- Pickleball courts
- Tennis courts
- Sand volleyball courts
- Skate parks
- Bike parks
- Disc golf courses
- Lawn bowling
- Horseshoes

Note: The focus of this study is outdoor amenities, however it is recognized that several types of activities and groups utilize both indoor and outdoor amenities.

Overview of the Current Inventory

City Owned/ Maintained Outdoor Sport Infrastructure

- 1 Synthetic Turf Field
- 20 Class A Natural Grass Fields
- 5 Class B Natural Grass Fields
- 2 Cricket
- 3 Sand Volleyball Court
- 15 Class A Natural Grass Ball Diamonds
- 11 Class B Natural Grass Ball Diamonds
- 1 Synthetic Turf Diamond
- 15 Sport Courts
- 1 Lacrosse Box
- 22 Pickleball Courts
- 13 Tennis Courts
- 17 Basketball Court
- 1 BMX Track
- 2 Skate Parks
- 24 Horseshoe Pits (Mill Lake Park)
- 1 Lawn Bowling Green
- 1 Track
- 2 Throwing Cages

School Board Owned Outdoor Sport Infrastructure*

4
Synthetic Turf Field

3
Mini Synthetic Turf Fields

7
Class A Natural Grass Fields

38
Class B Natural Grass Fields

1
Cricket

4
Class A Natural Grass Ball Diamonds

16
Class B Natural Grass Ball Diamonds

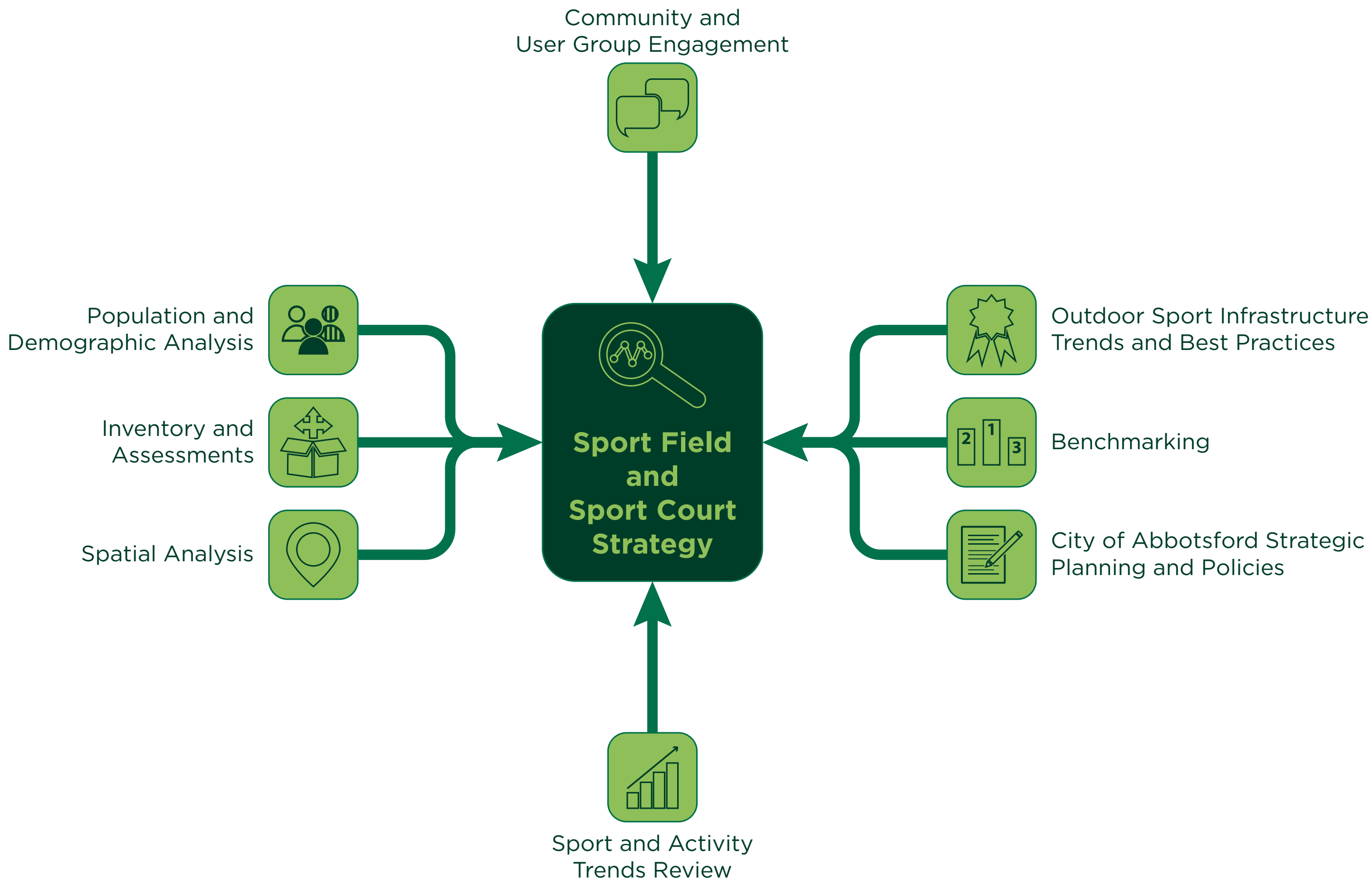
2
Tracks

**This only includes amenities booked by the City of Abbotsford within the last 5 years.*

1.2. Strategy Process and Inputs

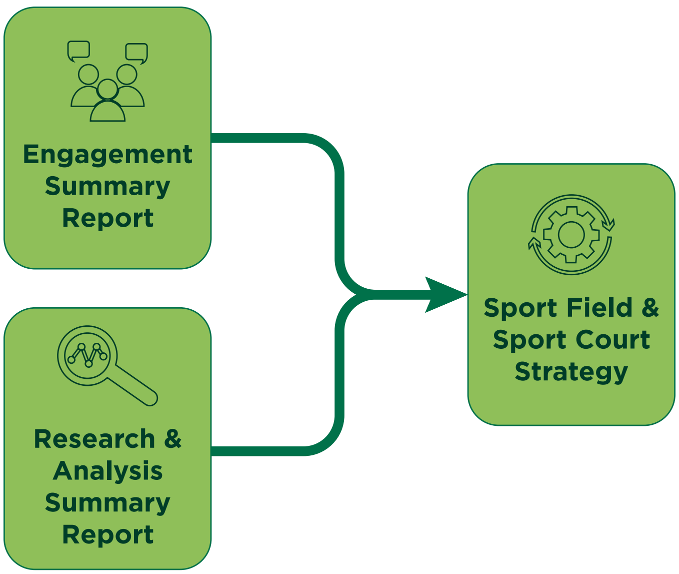
The draft actions contained in the Strategy emerged through extensive research and engagement aimed at understanding the current state of the outdoor sport amenity system in Abbotsford as well as anticipated future demands and needs. The following graphic summarizes these inputs.

Figure 1. Strategy Data and Analysis Inputs



The detailed insights generated through the research and engagement are compiled into two complementary documents to this Strategy – the Engagement Summary Report and the Research & Analysis Summary Report. Collectively, these two documents contain approximately 250 pages of data and analysis that provides the basis of information from which the Strategy was developed.

Figure 2. Overview of the Strategy Documents



The Engagement Summary Report and the Research & Analysis Summary Report can be accessed here.

2. SWOC Analysis & Strategic Goals for Outdoor Sport Amenities in Abbotsford

2.1. SWOC Analysis

The SWOC analysis (strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and challenges) on the following page coalesces the insights from the research and engagement into concise issues, topics, and planning considerations for subsequent sections of the Strategy to provide guidance on.

Strengths: includes aspects of planning and management that the City does well and overall strengths of the outdoor sport and recreation system.

Weaknesses: gaps within any of one of planning, management or the system itself (e.g. capacity, expertise, etc.).

Opportunities: includes aspects of infrastructure and service delivery that the City can actively leverage or improve to maximize community benefit from outdoor sport and recreation assets.

Challenges: Internal and external factors that could impact the City's ability to meet resident needs for outdoor sport and recreation opportunities.

Table 1. SWOC Analysis

Strengths	Weaknesses
• Expertise and capacity of many established / tenured sport field groups. • Commitment of the City to developing outdoor sport amenities in a strategic manner (as demonstrated by undertaking this Strategy and other related planning). • Distribution of fields and courts across the City appears to be relatively strong. While there is no standard benchmark for access and distribution, the majority (82%) of Abbotsford residents can access a court or field within an approximate 15-minute walk.	• Lack of data to understand spontaneous / casual use patterns for outdoor sport amenities. • User group frustration with field quality, suitability, and lack of new development. • Current lack of a major, multi-surface sport field hub site with spectator and tournament amenities. • Land supply for new outdoor sport amenity development.

Opportunities	Challenges
• Re-establishment of the joint use agreement with the Abbotsford School District and renewal of artificial turf fields. • Dispersing booked use across more fields and diamonds in the inventory. • Adding destination level fields, diamonds, and courts to the system over the long-term that can support increased tournament and event hosting. • Creating clear guidelines for how amenities should be developed, managed, and maintained. • Growth of activities like pickleball, wheeled sports, and cricket – therefore diversifying recreation and sport opportunities for residents.	• Long-term financial resource availability and competing municipal priorities. • Climate change impact on field quality and maintenance resources. • Dynamic and ever-evolving nature of sport and recreation activity trends, preferences, and delivery entities (e.g. private sector entities that deliver programming and/or infrastructure).

2.2. Draft Strategic Goals for Outdoor Sport Amenities in Abbotsford

The following draft Strategic Goals identify overall focus areas or “goalposts” for outdoor sport amenity management and investment in the city. These Goals leverage or build upon the identified strengths / opportunities and weaknesses / challenges highlighted in the SWOC analysis and articulate to the community where the City will focus its efforts aimed at optimizing provision. The draft actions in Section 3 of the Strategy build upon these Goals by identifying more specific tactics, tools, and approaches.

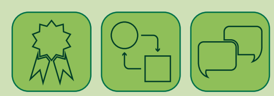
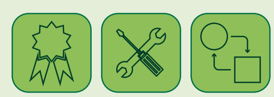
Table 2. Draft Strategic Goals for Outdoor Sport Amenities in Abbotsford

Draft Strategic Goal	Outcomes
 **Goal#1: Align outdoor sport amenity provision with best practice.**	By planning, designing, and maintaining outdoor sport amenities in alignment with national and provincial best practices, the City will optimize user experience and ensure that the inventory is best positioned to meet increasing demands as well as support both program and tournament / event-based uses.
 **Goal #2: Renew existing outdoor sport amenities in a targeted and strategic manner.**	Renewal of existing amenities should be a priority for the City as land and resourcing to develop new sites, while needed (as per Goal #3), has challenges. By optimizing high-value existing sites, the City will optimize existing assets and best position these sites for future use and community benefit.

Draft Strategic Goal	Outcomes
Goal #3: Grow the inventory to meet anticipated future growth.	The City will need to add incremental outdoor sport infrastructure to both meet existing gaps and anticipated future needs. Growing the inventory in a well-planned and rationalized manner will ensure that public funds support both structured and unstructured sport and recreation activities and align with broader City values, vision, and goals for the future. Key aspects of a well-planned system include balancing geographic distribution (continued access for most residents) with creating hubs that can support game and tournament play, developing sites that can be sustainably managed, and ensuring that outdoor sport and recreation infrastructure is adaptable as needs and trends evolve.
Goal #4: Ensure outdoor sport facilities and amenities balance meeting the unique needs of users with flexibility and adaptability.	Some types of outdoor sport activities require specialized and 'purposed' amenities. The City will develop these specialized amenities as supported by sound rationale, while also placing a focus on creating multi-use sites that support an array of activities and have the ability to adapt with trends. Striking this balance will make Abbotsford's city-wide inventory of outdoor sport amenities diverse and sustainable well into the future.
Goal #5: Continue to place a priority on user engagement and communications.	Outdoor sport amenity users, whether formally part of an organized group or unaffiliated / individual, are highly invested and interested in the future of these spaces. Communicating and dialoging with users on an ongoing basis will leverage their firsthand knowledge and expertise as well as help ensure maximum clarity on decision making.

3. Draft Actions

3.1. Draft Actions for the Management of Outdoor Sport Amenities

Summary of Draft Actions for the Management of Outdoor Sport Amenities	
Draft Actions	**Draft Strategic Goals Achieved by the Action** (See Section 2.2 for additional detail on each Goal)
A. Implement a new classification system for sport fields and diamonds.	
B. Continue to work towards aligning booked use of outdoor sport amenities with the City's Allocations Policy Framework.	
C. Undertake a review of operational and maintenance resourcing and practices.	
D. Invest in better understanding casual and spontaneous use of outdoor sport assets.	

Action A: Implement a new classification system for sport fields and diamonds.

The City currently classifies its sports field and ball diamond inventory using two classes – A and B. This classification system is not currently used across both management (e.g. allocations and bookings) and operations functions within the City. Establishing a more robust and consistently applied classification system will help ensure internal and external clarity on:

- Maintenance service levels;
- Support amenity provision;
- Types of play best suited for each field and diamond; and
- Standards / specs for capital field and diamond projects (including retrofits and renewals of existing facilities and the development of new ones).

Tables 3 - 5 provides an overview of the recommended draft classification system characteristics and attributes.

Table 3. Draft Sport Field Classification System Overview

Sport Field Attributes										
Field Class	Sports Turf Canada Field Class Equivalent	Field Structure	Field Civil Infrastructure - STM & WTR	Amenities: Lights	Amenities: Sport Furniture - Player Benches, Bleachers	Amenities: Sport Fitments - Goals	Sport Utilization	Best Practices	Field Size	Operation & Maintenance Input
Rating Scale			Yes/No/Optional	Yes/No/ Optional	Yes/No/Optional	Yes/No/ Optional	Hrs	Recommended Seasonal hours allocation - Further Discussion		$
*Artificial Turf		Synthetic Surface	Drainage Require	Recommended	Yes	Yes	Unlimited	Unlimited	Regulation / Multi-Use Capability	$$$$
Class A	Class 1	Sand - based Natural Grass	Drainage & Irrigation Required	Optional	Yes	Yes	600	"Permitted: 400 Hrs/ Season Rest period: May need significant time for restoration"	Regulation Field Size	$$$$
Class B-1	Class 2	Sand or Soil - based Natural Grass	Drainage & Irrigation Required	No	Optional	Optional	450	Permitted: 300 Hrs/ Season	Regulation Field Size	$$$
Class B-2	Class 4	Soil - based Natural Grass	Drainage & Irrigation Optional	No	Optional	Optional	300	Permitted: 150 Hrs/ Season	Non-Regulation / Mini Games	$$
Class C	Class 5	Variable	No	No	No	No	Variable - Site Specific on field surface	Variable	Non-Regulation	$

Table 4. Draft Ball Diamond Classification System Overview

Diamond Attributes											
				Amenities							
Diamond Class	Outfield Structure	Infield Structure	Field Civil Infrastructure - STM & WTR	Lights	Base Cut Outs	Outfield Fence	Sport Furniture - Player Benches, Bleachers	Sport Fitments - Bases, Backstops	Sport Utilization	Field Size	Operation & Maintenance Input
Rating Scale			Yes/No/Optional	Yes/No/ Optional	Yes/No/ Optional	Yes/No/ Temp	Yes/No/ Optional	Yes/No/ Optional	Hrs		$
Class A Single Use Sport - Baseball or Softball	Sand - based Natural Grass	Clay / gravel screenings	Drainage & Irrigation Required	Optional	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	600	Full Size Regulation for Sport	$$$$
Class B-1 Multi Sport (Baseball, Softball, Slo-Pitch)	Sand or Soil - based Natural Grass	Variable - Natural Grass, gravel screenings	Drainage & Irrigation Required	No	Optional	Temp	Optional	Optional	600	Non-Regulation / Mini Games	$$$
Class B-2 Multi Sport (Baseball, Softball, Slo-Pitch)	Soil - based Natural Grass	Variable - Natural Grass, gravel screenings	Not Required, but optional	No	Optional	Temp	Optional	Optional	300	Non-Regulation / Mini Games	$$
Class C Neighbourhood (Spontaneous)	Variable - Natural Grass or Gravel	Variable - Natural Grass, gravel	No	No	No	No	No	No	Variable - Site Specific on field surface	Non-Regulation	$

Table 5. Functional Use and Long-Term Development (LTD) Alignment of Each Class

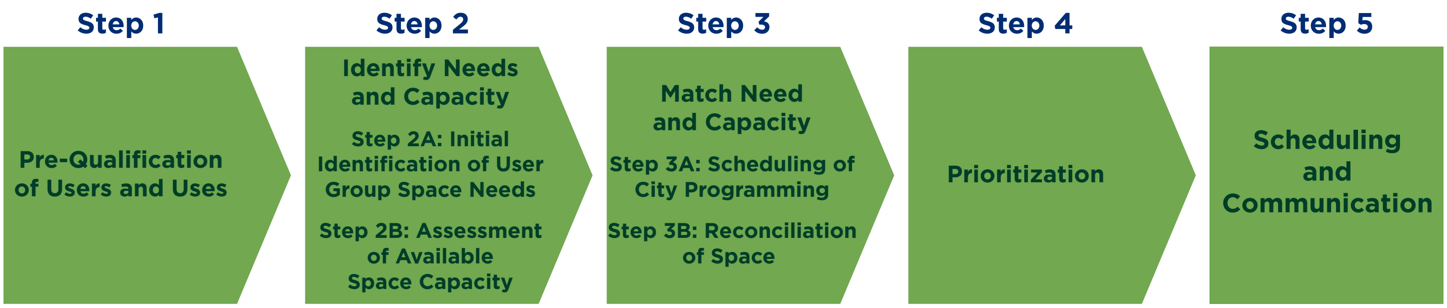
**Note: The terminology used by the various National Sport Organizations varies for their individuals plans (e.g. Long-Term Player Development, Long Term Athlete Development, etc.). LTD is the overarching term that encompasses the 8 Sport for Life Stages.*

Classification	Priority Types of Use	Targeted Sport for Life LTD Stages
Synthetic Turf	All	All
Class A	Game and tournament play as well as training for higher levels of sport	Train to Train Train to Compete Train to Win
Class B1	Game and tournament play and training	Active Start Fundamentals Learn to Train Train to Train Train to Compete Active for Life
Class B2	May accommodate some game play for recreation and younger age groups, however primary focus is training and spontaneous use	Active Start Fundamentals Learn to Train Active for Life
Class C	Spontaneous use	Active Start Fundamentals Active for Life

Action B: Continue to work towards aligning booked use of outdoor sport amenities with the City's Allocations Policy Framework.

In 2021 the City developed a new Allocation Policy Framework which was used to create a new Parks and Facilities Allocation Policy (C003-13). The Policy outlines a 5 Step Process for allocating bookable space as summarized by the following graphic from the Framework document.

Figure 3. Allocations Framework Process



A key element of Step 2A involves, where applicable, determining how much time a user group should be allocated in accordance with their National Sport Organization's (NSO) Long-Term Player Development plan or model (LTPD). National Sport Organization's (NSO's) are required to have a LTPD plan or model that aligns with Sport for Life's overall Long-Term Development approach. The LTPD models and plans created by NSO's across Canada vary in terms of specificity and format, but all generally provide guidance on the intensity, duration, and types of play that are appropriate for various age groups and levels within their sport.

It is recommended that the City continue using the Allocations Framework as an overall basis for allocating bookable space, recognizing that some flexibility and adaptability will be required and may require policy updates in the future. The City should also continue using the various LTPD plans and models to ensure the allocation of publicly supported space is appropriate and aligned with best practice. ***This analysis was undertaken to provide the City with an updated point of reference to inform future allocations decisions.***

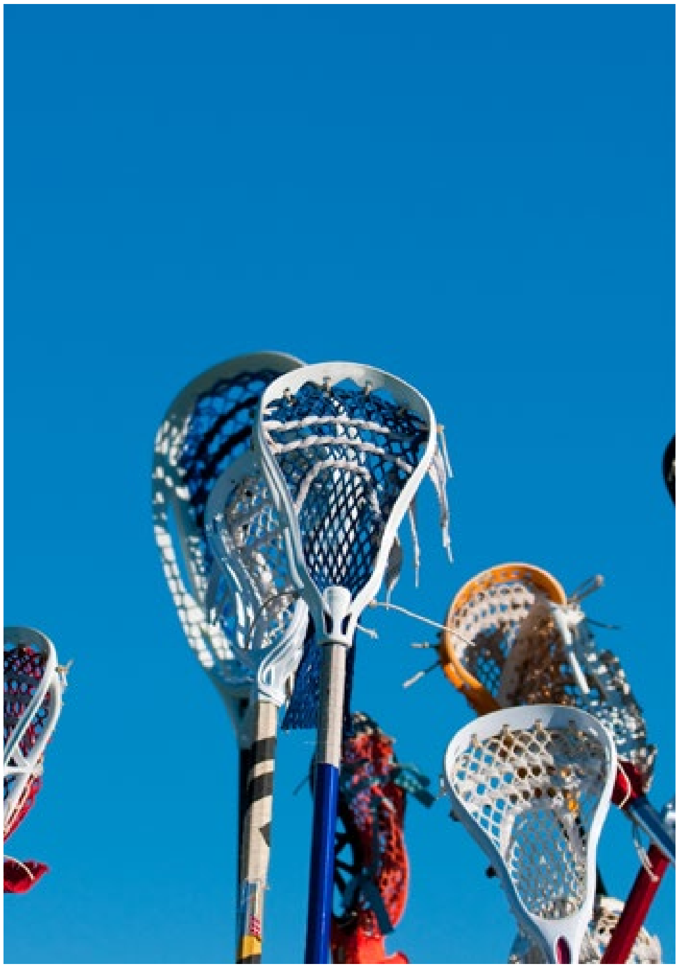
Implementation of the new approach to allocations will also need to continue involving significant engagement with user groups. When asked about satisfaction with the current allocations / permitting system, half of responding groups indicated a level of satisfaction while half indicated that they were dissatisfied. A deeper dive through the engagement into satisfaction levels with allocations and permitting indicates that access to facility time is the most significant concern.

On a move forward basis it will be important to communicate to groups the rationale for the new allocations approach, including:

- The importance of optimizing the existing inventory while planning and resource allocation occurs for capital projects (enhancements to existing and new sites).
- The need for the City to support both tenured and emerging groups.
- The importance of the City rationalizing how it allocates publicly supported space based on best practice.
- That the policy framework is not in-place to eliminate sports for various demographics, but rather foster collaboration between the City and groups.

Key Findings from the Engagement

- 64% of groups that responded to the Group Survey indicated that they cannot access enough field time to meet their programming needs.
- 93% of groups that responded to the Group Survey indicated that they use all of the time that they book.



Action C: Undertake a review of operational and maintenance resourcing and practices.

The community and user group engagement indicated that concerns exist with outdoor sport amenity quality in the city. These perceptions contrast somewhat with the preliminary functional analysis conducted for the Strategy which reflect that the majority of sport fields, diamonds, and courts are in moderate to good condition based on industry standards.

To provide a more in-depth and robust data point on the quality and condition of these assets, the City is currently undertaking a more thorough assessment. This technical work is being conducted parallel to the Sport Field and Sport Court Strategy.

The findings from this additional investigation will inform a comprehensive plan for how the City conducts ongoing field maintenance, repair, scheduling, and other related functions in alignment with best practices. Additionally, this work will help the City optimize its operations of the sport field inventory by informing:

- Annual, monthly, and weekly maintenance practices and schedules.
- Issues identification processes and responses/actions.
- How to work towards aligning with a new classification system.

Key Findings from the Engagement

- 42% of Resident Survey respondents identified dissatisfaction with the quality of sport fields in the city (42% were satisfied and 16% were unsure or had no opinion).
- 38% of Resident Survey respondents identified dissatisfaction with the quality of ball diamond in the city (28% were satisfied and 34% were unsure or had no opinion).
- 39% of Resident Survey respondents identified dissatisfaction with the quality of sport courts in the city (42% were satisfied and 19% were unsure or had no opinion).
- Concerns over sport field and ball diamond maintenance and upkeep were frequently cited during the user group engagements.

A future extension of the ongoing analysis should also look at best practices in turf and court surface maintenance in like-climate region and a comparison of resourcing (e.g. dollars invested annually per sport field or court, dollars invested in outdoor amenity operations per capita, etc.).

Action D: Invest in better understanding casual and spontaneous use of outdoor sport assets.

The City has a good understanding of organized sport use of field, diamonds, and courts as these amenities are booked. While the nature of these amenities is such that there may be some unused time or overbooking to account for weather, the City's bookings data can be assumed to provide a fairly accurate portrayal of how well these spaces are used for programming, games, and tournaments. However, the City does not have a comprehensive understanding of utilization volume or patterns pertaining to casual use of outdoor sport amenities.

Better understanding casual use (also often referred to as "unstructured" or "spontaneous") can help support both capital planning and the ongoing management of these assets by providing valuable insights on:

- Frequency of use
- Types of use
- Seasonal patterns of use (e.g. day vs evening, weekend vs weekday, etc.)
- Duration of stay at the respective sites
- Geographic distribution of use across the city

Several methods and tactics can be employed to gather this data, including:

- Purchase of movement data from third party providers.
- Implementing a spot count program (e.g. as part of operations staff's daily work protocol, via part-time and seasonal staff, etc.).
- Motion sensors.

3.2. Draft Actions for Field & Diamond Sports

Summary of Draft Actions for Field and Diamond Sports	
Draft Actions	**Draft Strategic Goals Achieved by the Action** **(See Section 2.2 for additional detail on each Goal)**
A. Target adding 3 – 6 high quality sports fields over the next ten years, in alignment with community growth, including one new synthetic turf field.	
B. Increase functional ball diamond capacity through a combination of improvements to existing diamonds and the addition of 3 - 4 new Class A diamonds.	
C. Continue to explore site options to develop a new sports and recreation park in Abbotsford.	
D. Continue to engage with the cricket community to plan for the future of the sport in Abbotsford and associated infrastructure needs.	

Figure 4. The Current Natural Grass Sport Field Inventory in Abbotsford

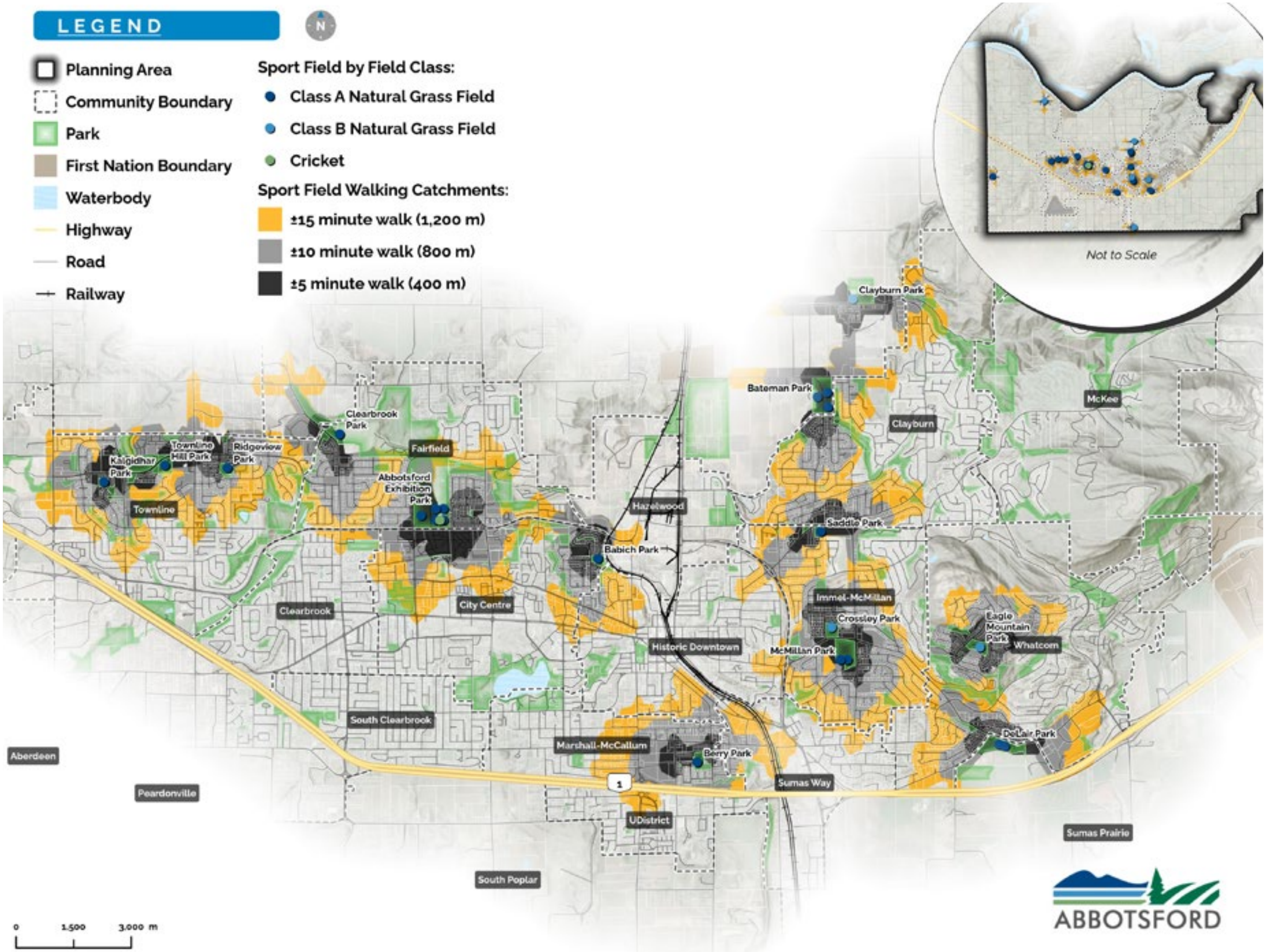


Figure 5. The Current Synthetic Turf Field Inventory in Abbotsford

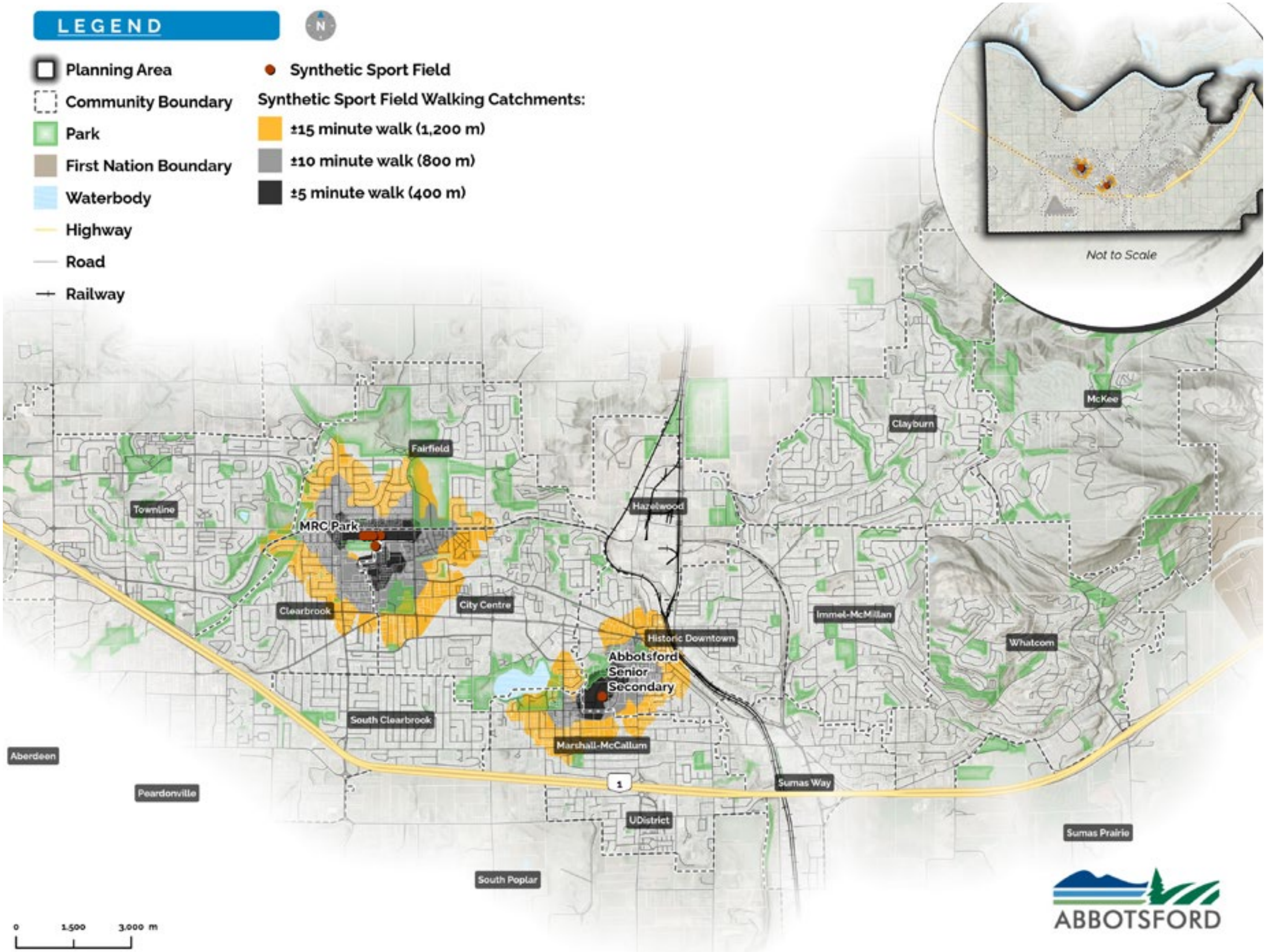
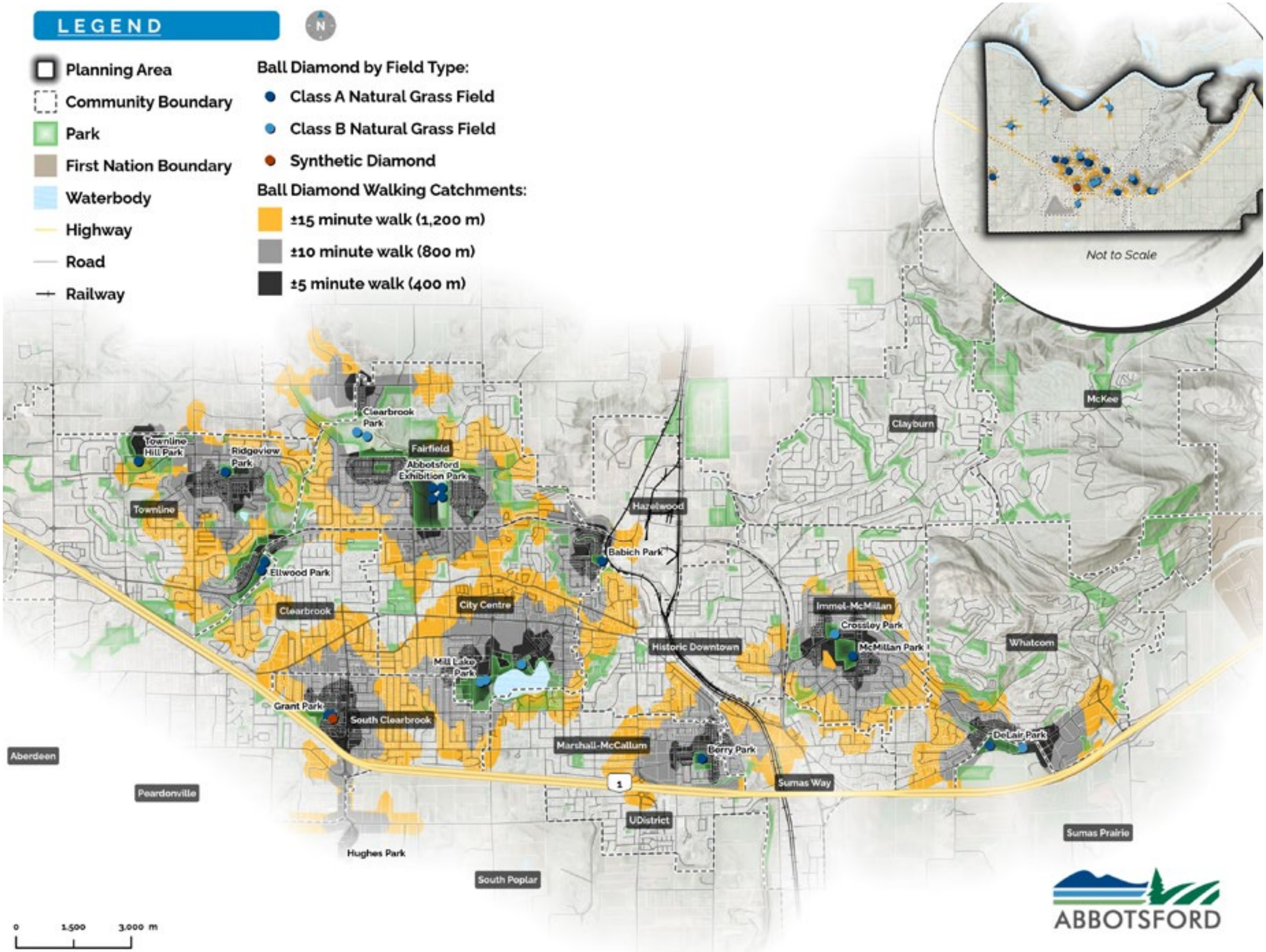


Figure 6. The Current Ball Diamond Inventory in Abbotsford



Key Facts and Stats About Sport Fields and Ball Diamonds in Abbotsford

- 59% of residents can access a Class A sport field within a 15-minute walk (43% can access one of these fields within a 10-minute walk). 12% of residents can access a Class B field within a 15-minute walk (8% can access one of these fields within a 10-minute walk).
- 57% of residents can access a Class A ball diamond within a 15 minute walk (40% can access one of these diamonds within a 10-minute walk). 34% of residents can access a Class B diamond within a 15-minute walk (22% can access one of these diamonds within a 10-minute walk).
- Cost recovery varies significantly by the type of field or diamond. Synthetic turf fields operate a positive cost recovery position (150% of expenses were recovered by revenues in 2024) while natural grass fields and diamonds require a significant ongoing subsidy (cost recovery was 3% in 2024). In 2024, the cost (subsidy) to provide a bookable hour of natural grass field and diamond time was $14.29. However, it is important to note that these figures do not include capital reserve and lifecycle replacement costs which are higher for some fields types than others (e.g. a synthetic turf field requires replacement every 10-15 years).
- In 2023 and 2024, 84% of all prime time synthetic field capacity and 92% of Class A rectangular sport field capacity was booked. Conversely, only 28% of Class B rectangular sport field capacity was booked.
- Similar to the rectangular fields, ball user groups have strong preference for the higher quality surfaces. Over the past three years over 90% of available Class A diamond capacity has been booked, compared to only 27-40% of Class B diamond capacity during this same period of time.

By the Numbers – The Rectangular Sport Field and Ball Diamond Inventory

- 5 total synthetic turf fields (1 owned by the City)
- 25 total Class A grass rectangular sport fields (20 owned by the City)*
- 43 total Class B grass rectangular sport fields (5 owned by the City)*
- 3 mini-fields
- 3 cricket pitches (2 owned by the City)
- 19 Class A ball diamonds (15 owned by the City)
- 27 Class B ball diamonds (11 owned by the City)
- 1 ball diamond with synthetic turf

**Classes defined using the City's current classification system (recommended for adjustment as per Section 3.1.)*

Action A: Target adding 3 – 6 high quality sports fields over the next ten years, in alignment with community growth, including one new synthetic turf field.

The following table summarizes the current inventory of rectangular sport fields in Abbotsford, including those fields owned by the City and School District. ***Note: the classes identified in the table use the City's existing system for classifying fields. Reclassification and the addition of a Class C is recommended as per Action A in Section 3.1.***

Table 6. Rectangular Sport Field Inventory Summary

Field Type	City Owned	School District Owned	Total
Synthetic Turf	1	4	5
Natural Grass Class A	20	5	25
Natural Grass Class B	5	38	43
Mini Fields	0	3	3

Table 7 identifies several key considerations and inputs that should be used to assess whether the City's current level of service is appropriate and to help set future targets. These considerations and inputs suggest that:

- The City's overall level of rectangular field provision is generally similar to regional comparators.
- High quality fields (synthetic turf and Class A as per the City's current classification system) are well used and approaching capacity, while a fair amount of capacity exists within fields currently identified as Class B.
- Some capacity will be required to sustain existing service levels based on anticipated growth.

Table 7. Potential Service Level Considerations and Inputs

Field Type	Current Service Level*	Regional Benchmarking Comparison (Average)**	Additional Fields Required by 2035 to Sustain Existing Service Levels Based on Projected Growth***	Utilization Indicators
Synthetic Turf	1: 30,705 residents	1:24,914 residents	+1	• 84% of available capacity is currently booked.
Natural Grass Fields	1: 6,141 residents (all classes of natural grass fields)	1: 5,076 residents	+4 Class A fields +1 Class B field +1 Mini-field	• 92% of Class A field capacity is booked (based on 450 hours of annual capacity). • 28% of Class B field capacity is booked (based on 450 hours of annual capacity).

**Reflects all (City and School) synthetic turf fields and only City owned natural grass fields.*

***Comparators: City of Delta, City of Burnaby, City of Chilliwack, City of Coquitlam, City of Port Coquitlam, City of Richmond, Township of Langley, City of New Westminster, City of North Vancouver, District of North Vancouver, City of Maple Ridge. These comparator jurisdictions were selected based on a combination of regional provision similarities, population size, and the availability of data.*

****Based on BC Stats growth projections of 185,960 residents by 2035 (approximately 13,000 more than the current population)*

Based on the considerations and inputs presented in Table 7, adding 3 – 6 additional high quality rectangular fields to the inventory over the next 10 years is a reasonable target for the City. Ideally, one of these surfaces should be synthetic turf to maximize the year-round capacity benefit and make the most efficient use of limited land resources. The following table reflects the capacity benefit of synthetic turf compared to natural grass fields.

Table 8. Synthetic Turf Capacity Comparison to Natural Grass

Field Type	Annual Capacity per field	Rationale
Synthetic Turf	3,000 hours (1,800 – 2,000 prime time hours) **Assumes fields are lit*	Synthetic turf maximum hours are based on Manufacturer's Warranty Standard, Sports Turf Canada. Prime time reflect weekday evenings (e.g. 5 pm – 10 pm) and weekends (e.g. 8 am – 8 pm) depending on the availability of lighting and staffing.
Natural Grass	300 - 600	Natural grass field capacity is based on using a field within what its surface can sustain before damage occurs. Sport Turf Canada identified best practices based on the classification and characteristics of different field surfaces and build typologies (refer to the recommended classification system in Section 3.1.).

Table 9 further outlines the capacity impact of developing one synthetic turf field over the next decade. As reflected by the table, the development of synthetic turf would add nearly double the capacity to the system. While synthetic turf has a significantly higher capital cost and lifecycle replacement requirement (10-15 year lifespan), these costs are often mitigated by the ability to more efficiently use land supply and concentrate use at a single site which creates efficiencies with support amenity development and maintenance.

Table 9. Potential Approaches to Adding Field Capacity

Scenario	Capacity Added to the System
City develops 1 artificial turf field + 2 Class A natural surface fields	3,000+ total prime time hours (1,800+ for the synthetic field + 1,200 for the Class A natural surface fields)
City develops 3 Class A fields	1,800 total hours (3 Class A fields x 600 hours per field)

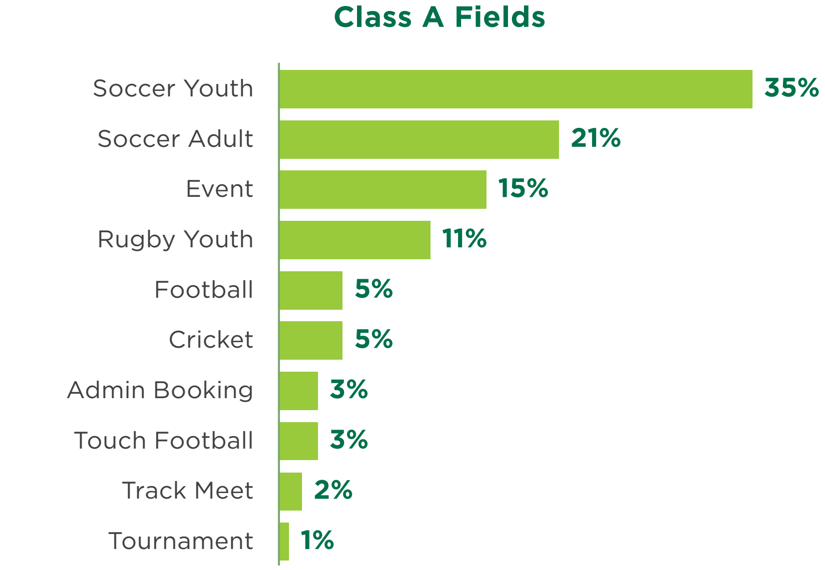
Adding 3 – 6 premium quality rectangular sport fields to the inventory may require some additional land to be secured (see Action C in this section) but could also utilize existing sport field sites in the following ways:

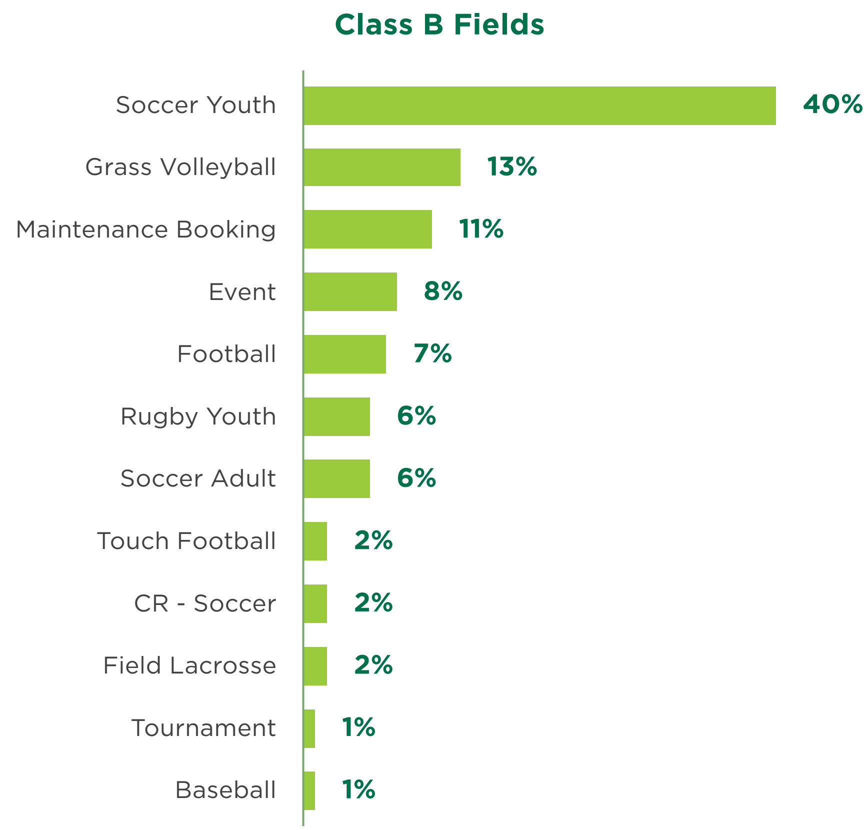
- Improving selected fields currently identified as Class B fields to a Class A standard.
- Retrofitting an existing natural grass field into a synthetic turf field.

The City will also need to determine how to deliver the recommended new synthetic turf field. Currently, 4 of the 5 synthetic turf fields in Abbotsford are on school property with community access through a joint use agreement. The City will need to weigh the pros and cons of developing a new synthetic turf field through a partnership with the School District, another entity, or developing this new amenity on City owned and managed lands.

It will also be important for the City to test future supply needs on an ongoing basis which could require the recommended targets of 3 – 6 premium fields to be adjusted up or down based on several factors, including field sport trends and the ongoing implementation of the new allocations approach. While soccer is a primary user of the rectangular sport fields in the city, the inventory supports a wide array of different outdoor sports. As field enhancements, retrofits and new projects are further refined, sited, and designed, it will be extremely important for the City to assess system wide impacts of adding supply and how allocations of existing and new rectangular fields can best align the right users with the right fields.

Figure 7. Bookings of Rectangular Sports Fields by Activity Type





Additional Sport Field Provision Considerations

Multi-Activity Field Alternatives

The provision targets identified for sport fields and ball diamonds (see the following draft action) reflect individual surfaces. However, a couple alternative approaches exist that could help reduce these provision targets and make optimal use of limited land:

- Creation of multi-activity or "crossover" sites that include an infield to support ball and an outfield that can be used for full-sized or mini-field sport fields.
- Designing future sport fields in a manner that provides flexibility with different orientations (e.g. full size and mini-field configurations).
- Adding a ball infield, backstop, and other infrastructure (e.g. benches/dugout) to a new artificial turf field. Regional examples exist that have been successful in other jurisdictions (e.g. Telosky Stadium in Maple Ridge).

The consideration of these alternatives will need to factor in seasonality of use by the different activity types and how allocations could occur at these sites to ensure sport field and ball use can occur efficiently and benefits both types of activity groups.

What about a 20-year horizon?

The provision targets for sports fields and ball are based generally on a 10-15 year horizon as this is a reasonable timeframe to predict trends and impacts of overall population growth on participant numbers. Looking further into the horizon, if sport field and ball diamond trends remain similar and the City achieves the population growth targets identified by the updated OCP (Abbotsforward), BC Stats, Fraser Valley Regional Growth Strategy, and other available sources, it is reasonable to project that an additional 5-10 surfaces (sports field and diamonds combined) will likely be required over the next 20-25 years as the City grows to between 200,000 and 250,000 residents. However, it will be important for the City and its partners to continue revisiting future needs and set long-term targets in consideration of the following variables:

- Sport activity trends
- Retrofits and improvements to the existing inventory (impacts on the capacity and functionality achieved through these projects)
- Field surface typology (e.g. creating sites that can accommodate higher volumes of use through the use of artificial turf, multi-activity sites, multi-field 'hub' sites, etc.)

Action B: Increase functional ball diamond capacity through a combination of improvements to existing diamonds and the addition of 3 - 4 new Class A diamonds.

The following table summarizes the current ball diamond inventory in Abbotsford using the existing system for classifying these fields.

Table 10. Overview of the Ball Diamond Inventory

Field Type	City Owned	School District Owned	Total
Class A Ball Diamonds	15	4	19
Class B Ball Diamonds	11	16	27
Synthetic Turf Ball Diamonds	1	0	1

The overall service level of diamonds in Abbotsford on a provision level basis (residents per diamond) is similar to regional comparators. However, these diamonds are booked to near capacity and feedback through the community engagement highlighted concerns over overall field access and quality.

Table 11. Potential Service Level Considerations and Inputs

Current Service Level*	Regional Benchmarking Comparison (Average)**	Additional Fields Required by 2035 to Sustain Existing Service Levels Based on Projected Growth***	Utilization Indicators
1 Class A diamond: 10,235 residents 1 Class B diamond: 13,956 residents **Overall Service Level: 1 diamond: 5,905 residents** *1 ball diamond at Grant Park has synthetic turf.	1:5,841 residents	+3 Class A diamonds +3 Class B diamonds	• Class A: 90% of capacity is booked (average of 2023 and 2024) • Class B: 27- 40% of Class B diamond capacity is booked (average of 2023 and 2024)

**Reflects all (City and School) synthetic turf fields and only City owned natural grass fields.*

***Comparators: City of Delta, City of Burnaby, City of Chilliwack, City of Coquitlam, City of Port Coquitlam, City of Richmond, Township of Langley, City of New Westminster, City of North Vancouver, District of North Vancouver, City of Maple Ridge. These comparator jurisdictions were selected based on a combination of regional provision similarities, population size, and the availability of data.*

****Based on BC Stats growth projections of 185,960 residents by 2035 (approximately 13,000 more than the current population)*

Meeting current and anticipated future needs for ball diamonds in Abbotsford can best be accommodated through enhancements to existing diamonds and the addition of some new supply (3-4 new diamonds). A key differentiating factor between rectangular sport fields and ball diamonds is the multi-use utility of these surfaces. Rectangular sport fields can serve a multitude of field sports and are highly adaptable for different age groups (e.g. can be divided into half, third, or quarter field lengths for practices and games for younger age groups). As such the risk of oversupplying a community with rectangular sports fields is low. Conversely, ball diamonds can have some flexibility but require certain dimensions and specialization to accommodate different levels, age groups, and types of ball.

Future capital investment into ball diamond infrastructure will need to balance increasing capacity and meeting ball group needs with managing risk and making optimal use of limited land supply. The following tactics are recommended to help strike this balance and advance the recommended action:

- Identify existing diamonds that are prime candidates for surface and amenity upgrades (e.g. lighting) that can improve capacity. This could include Class A diamonds that are currently underutilized and / or Class B diamonds with potential to be upgraded to Class A quality.
- Consider a ball diamond inclusion in the new artificial turf field recommended under the previous action pertaining to rectangular sport fields.
- Continue to identify opportunities to create efficiency and open up capacity through implementation of the new allocations policy and ongoing validation of user group bookings in alignment with LTD guidance.
- Add the additional diamonds as part of a ‘hub’ site as per the following action. The specific dimensions and typologies for these diamonds should be further explored through conceptual planning once a site has been identified.

Action C: Continue to explore site options to develop a new sports and recreation park in Abbotsford.

The need for, and benefits of, developing a new major sports park in Abbotsford is referenced in previous City planning, including the 2018 Parks, Recreation & Culture Master Plan. The Master Plan identifies that clustering diamonds and sport fields on a single site can create support amenity efficiencies and enhance tournament hosting capacity. Trends, analysis of the current sport field system, and the engagement conducted for the Strategy support this previous Master Plan direction.

Long-Term Direction Identified in the City's 2018 Parks, Recreation and Culture Master Plan

"Explore funding options to support a multi-sport outdoor tournament facility"
(Section 8.5.4.1)

Key Findings from the Research and Engagement that Support Developing a New Sports Park Site

- Resident Survey respondents and engaged user groups indicated a strong preference for high quality, "hub" sites that can accommodate multiple activities at the same time and increase tournament hosting opportunities.
- Support amenities are important to sport field users. 70% of Resident Survey respondents identified washrooms as a priority for sport field site enhancement / investment. Approximately one-third also identified parking and seating as being desired priorities for enhanced. These types of support amenities are best delivered at a sports park as they can service multiple surfaces and provide site maintenance and operational efficiencies.
- While it is important to ensure residents have walkable access to sites that can support casual play in or adjacent to their neighbourhood, providing a handful of sport park sites within a city can support increased participation in organized outdoor sports by allowing program providers to be more efficient and effective (e.g. coaches and volunteers can transition between groups) and creating better experiences for participants as a result of better support amenities and a progression of fields / diamonds (e.g. multiple diamonds of different dimensions can be developed on a single site for participants to progress through).

The future targets identified in the previous two actions suggest that 3 – 6 rectangular fields and 3-4 diamonds will be needed to support future growth over the next 10 years. While a few of these surfaces could be accommodated through enhancements or retrofits to existing sport field and diamond sites, the majority of incremental growth to the inventory is likely to require lands outside of the existing inventory. **Delivering as many of these field and diamond surfaces as possible on a single, major new sports park site is recommended as the optimal approach.** The following table identifies a potential site program and future planning considerations. To accommodate this program, a site of approximately 40 – 50 hectares will be required.

Table 12. Potential New Sports Park Program

Infrastructure	Potential Characteristics	Future Planning Considerations
Natural Surfaces	• Up to 5 natural grass rectangular fields, ideally all Class A to support tournament hosting and game play. • Up to 4 Class A diamonds.	• Key surface characteristics to further examine through site specific design and user engagement should include: » The optimal mix of dedicated vs multi-activity surfaces (e.g. fenced diamonds vs those with cross-over potential for sport field and ball use). » Field dimensions required to meet all anticipated uses of the site. » Diamond dimensions and amenities based on the targeted types of ball to be allocated to the site. » The cost-benefit of lighting some or all surfaces. • Recommended that the City engage with the cricket community and assess the viability of including cricket infrastructure on one of the natural surface fields.

Infrastructure	Potential Characteristics	Future Planning Considerations
Synthetic Surfaces	• 1 synthetic turf field as part of the initial site build.	• The site should be designed to easily enable additional synthetic turf fields to be created (through a retrofit of natural surface fields if required over the long-term). • Planning for the synthetic turf surface should include engagement with all sport field users, including field hockey, football, field lacrosse, and soccer to assess how their needs could be accommodated at the site or provide broader system benefits such as increased capacity at other sites (e.g. through a re-allocation of where different activities take place). • Recommended that the opportunity to include a ball diamond infield as part of the potential new synthetic turf field be considered in order to further increase capacity and support shoulder season play.
Fieldhouse	• 1 field house equipped with changerooms, washrooms, and a tournament room/meeting room.	• Additional engagement with user groups should be undertaken during future stages of planning and design on specific characteristics, anticipated types and levels of use, etc.
Additional Support Amenities	• Parking • Storage • Scoreboards • Spectator seating • Batting cages • Food services areas • Other features and amenities (e.g. children's play area, etc.).	• Parking needs and requirements to be verified through a parking and traffic assessment during future stages of planning and design. • Engagement with user groups will help inform future considerations related to storage, spectator seating, training and warm-up spaces, etc. • Food services could be provided through a permanent structure (e.g. integrated into the field house) or through an area equipped for food trucks or other non-permanent approaches.

Action D: Continue to engage with the cricket community to plan for the future of the sport in Abbotsford and associated infrastructure needs.

There are currently three cricket pitches in Abbotsford at the following locations:

- Abbotsford Exhibition Park
- Bakerview Cricket Grounds
- McMillan Park

Two of these sites (Abbotsford Exhibition Park and Bakerview Cricket Grounds) are regularly booked by cricket groups and are collectively well used. **The McMillan Park site is not booked due to irrigation issues and other park uses impacted by cricket.*

Table 13. Overview of Cricket Capacity and Utilization

Site	Annual Capacity*	Hours Booked (2024)	% of Capacity Used (2024)
Abbotsford Exhibition Park	600 hours annually	492 hours**	82%
Bakerview	600 hours annually	316 hours	53%
Total	**1,200**	**808**	**67%**

**Based on a capacity assumption of 600 hours annually.*

***Accommodating cricket at the AEP requires two fields to be booked simultaneously.*

The Abbotsford Cricket Club has approximately 300 members and 16 teams and remains the primary organized cricket group in the city, however several other small groups have formed in recent years. It is recommended that the City continue to engage with the cricket community, including tenured and emerging groups, to ensure a comprehensive understanding of future space needs. **As mentioned in draft Action C, opportunities to include cricket infrastructure as part of a new major sports park development should be explored. Alternatively, shifting other sport field activities and groups from existing sites to a new major sports park could provide opportunities to retrofit one or more of those existing sites for cricket.**

3.3. Draft Actions for Sport Courts

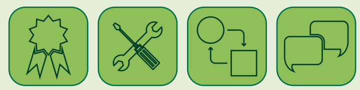
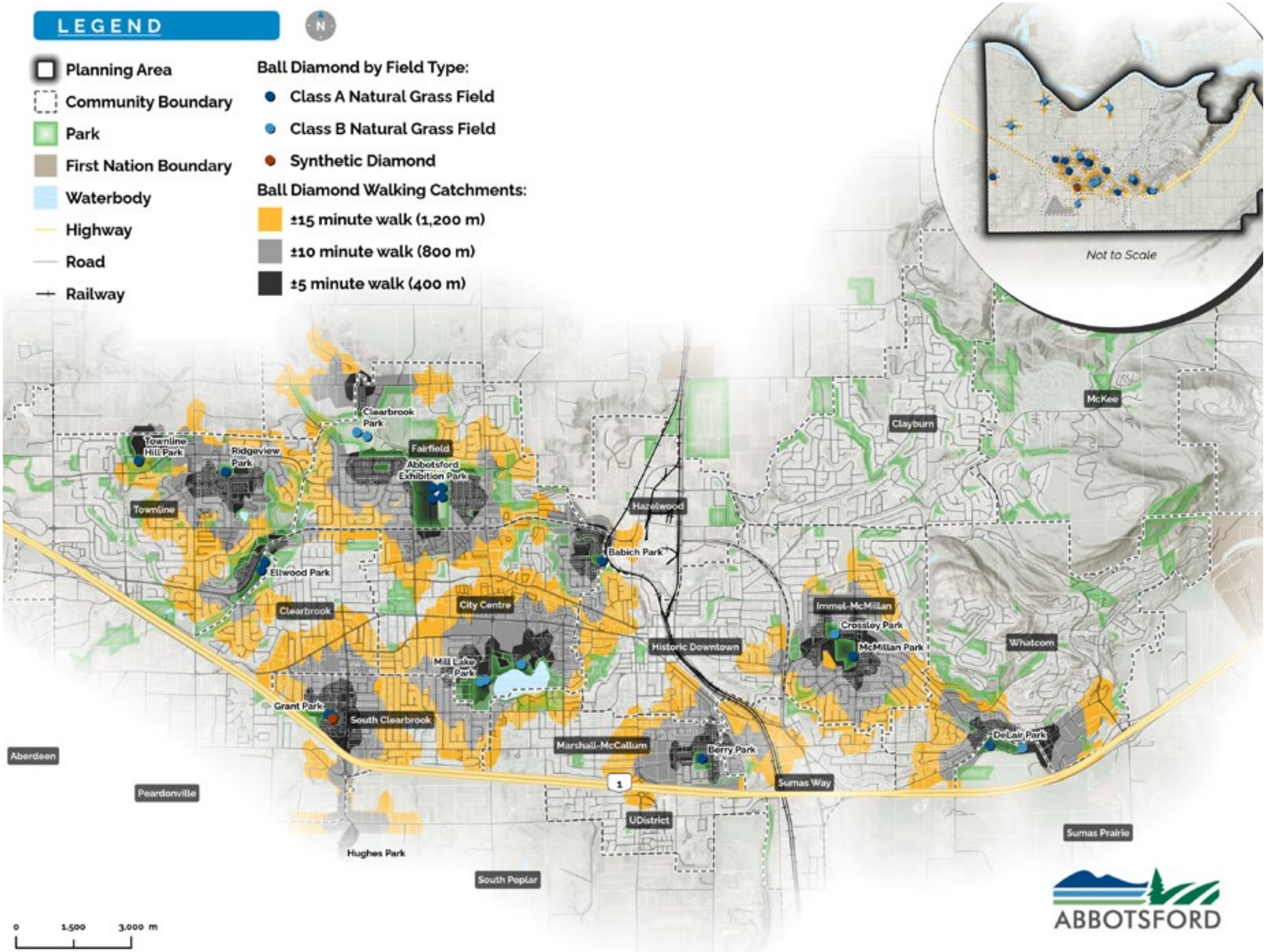
Summary of the Draft Actions for Sport Courts	
Draft Actions	**Draft Strategic Goals Achieved by the Action** **(See Section 2.2 for additional detail on each Goal)**
A. Develop a comprehensive renewal plan for the sport court inventory.	
B. Use the recommended provision (service level) targets and approaches as a point of reference for future planning but validate and revisit on an ongoing basis.	
C. Remain open to non-traditional and creative solutions to meeting sport court demands.	

Figure 8. The Current Sport Court Inventory in Abbotsford



Key Facts and Stats About Sport Courts in Abbotsford

- 61% of residents can access a basketball court within a 15-minute walk and 49% can access a multi-use sport court within a 15-minute walk. By comparison, tennis and pickleball courts are less well distributed with only 16% and 18% respectively able to access these court types within a 15-minute walk.
- The majority of sport court use occurs casually and is not formally booked through the City's system. Sport court amenities with the most booked hours in recent years were the lacrosse box (1,024 booked hours in 2024) and pickleball courts (690 booked hours in 2023). Opportunities exist to better understand court utilization.
- Most aspects of court surfaces in the city were identified as being in good or moderate condition, however the need for renewal of some surfaces and amenities (e.g. fencing, boards, nets, etc.) were noted during the site reviews.

By the Numbers – The Sport Court Inventory

- 3 sand volleyball courts (all City owned)
- 15 multi-use sport courts
- 1 lacrosse box
- 22 pickleball courts (all City owned)
- 13 tennis courts (all City owned)
- 17 basketball courts (not including courts on school property with varying levels of public access)

Action A: Develop a comprehensive renewal plan for the sport court inventory.

Sport courts provide low barrier, multi-generational opportunities for a variety of casual, semi-organized, and organized sport and recreation. Sustaining court safety, visual appeal / aesthetics, and the functional qualities that contribute to positive experiences will be important into the future to maximize the benefits provided by these spaces. High-level, functional assessments conducted by technical members of the Strategy team looked at key aspects of court condition as summarized by Table 14.

Table 14. Condition Summary for Key Elements of City Managed Sport Courts in Abbotsford

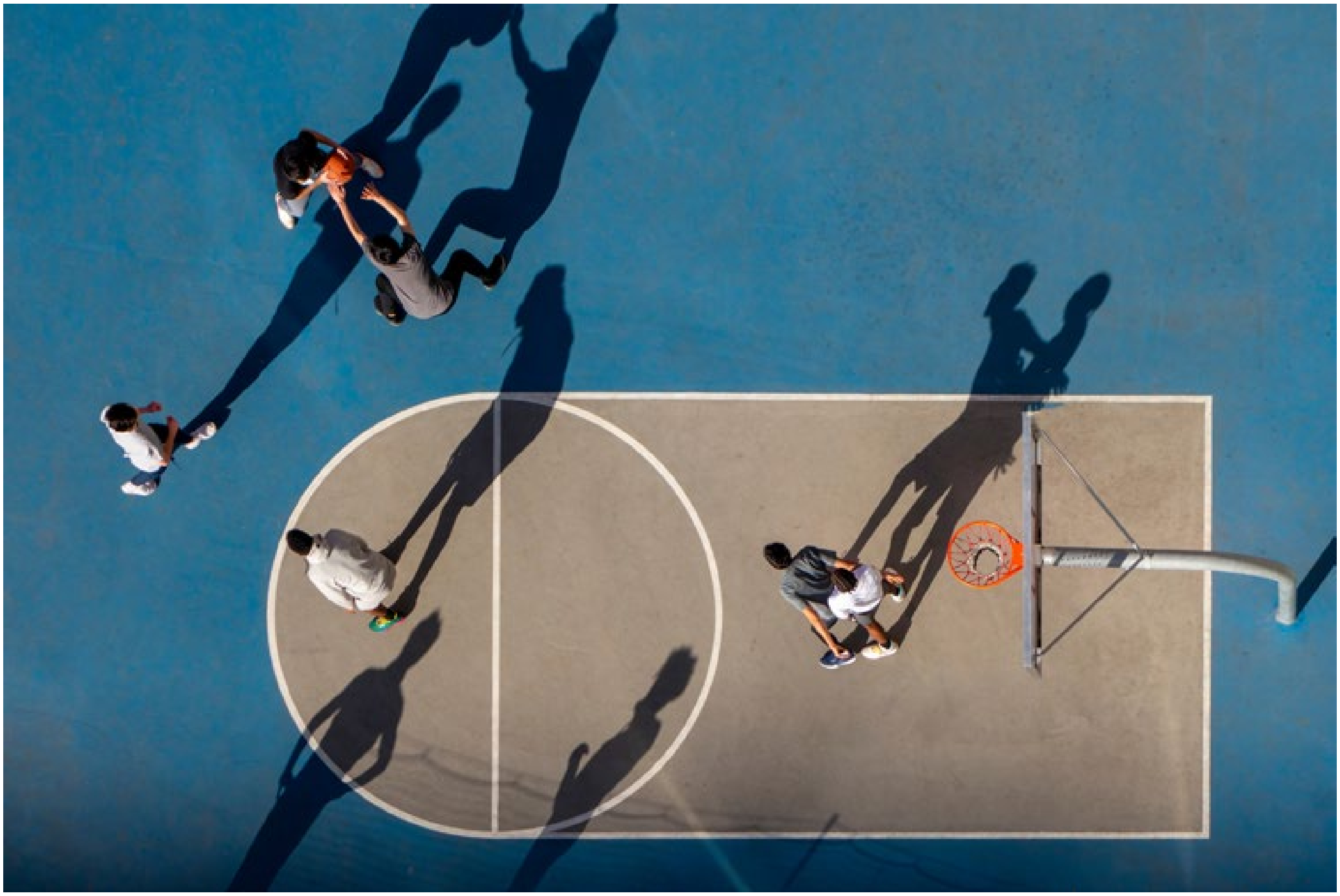
Sport Court Element	Assessed as being in "Very Good" condition	Assessed as being in "Good" condition	Assessed as being in "Moderate" condition	Assessed as being in "Poor" or "Very Poor" condition
Pickleball and Tennis Courts – Surfacing	17	12	3	2
Pickleball and Tennis Courts - Fencing	4	12	21	2
Basketball and Sport Courts – Surfacing	3	7	8	1
Basketball and Sport Courts – Fencing	1	4	5	2

Additional detail on the sport court assessments can be found in the Research and Analysis Summary Report

It is recommended that the City use the data from the assessments, other existing inspection reports, and staff knowledge to develop a comprehensive, long-term plan for sport court renewals that includes:

- A schedule for surfacing repairs and replacements.
- A schedule for the repair or replacement of key amenities and sport court elements (e.g. fencing, nets, benches, etc.).

The plan should also identify costs pertaining to the above items and prioritize these investments based on factors of risk, current use, and site context (e.g. opportunities to undertake these works along with those conducted on adjacent amenities, considerations pertaining to the future of the site, neighbourhood need, etc.).



Action B: Use the recommended provision (service level) targets and approaches as a point of reference for future planning but validate and revisit on an ongoing basis.

Findings from the engagement support that sport courts are highly valued by residents and a key aspect of the City's recreation portfolio. Many residents would also like to see the City increase and improve supply as the city grows into the future. While data inputs such as engagement findings, benchmarking (comparison to other jurisdictions), and trends are helpful in setting future provision targets, the City does not have a comprehensive understanding of how well sport courts are used as the majority of sport court activity occurs spontaneously and is not formally booked. Better understanding utilization volume and patterns should be a priority for the City to support future planning on a system wide and site by site basis (see Section 3.1. for suggested tactics to improving the collection of casual use data).

Key Findings from the Engagement

- When asked about their household's ability to access a sport court close to where they live, 47% of Resident Survey respondents indicated a level of satisfaction with 38% indicating a level of dissatisfaction (15% were unsure / no opinion).
- 43% of Resident Survey respondents expressed a level of satisfaction with the quality of courts in the city, while 39% were dissatisfied (18% were unsure).
- 98% of Resident Survey respondents believe that having outdoor sport and recreation amenities in their community or neighbourhood are beneficial regardless of whether people directly use them or not.
- The top three courts types identified by respondents as requiring development or enhancement were: dedicated pickleball courts (69% identified the need to develop or enhance), basketball courts (49% identified the need to develop or enhance), and mixed use tennis courts (46% identified the need to develop or enhance).

The provision (service level) targets and approaches identified in Table 16 should be considered as an initial reference point for future planning. These targets reflect three approaches for future supply across the various court types:

Increase the level of provision. Suggests that the City should improve the current number of residents per court by sustaining what exists plus undertaking new development that occurs more aggressively than the rate of population growth. This provision approach is rationalized based on trends, indicators of demand and need from the engagement, and current supply characteristics.

Consider a Decrease in the Provision Level. Suggests a decrease in service levels, allowing the number of residents per court to expand. This could occur through not developing court amenities in alignment with growth and/or decommissioning some selected existing courts. This approach would be rationalized if trends and demand indicators suggest an oversupply.

Sustain the Provision Level. Suggests keeping the number of residents per court generally the same by sustaining what exists plus undertaking new development that generally occurs in lockstep with population growth. This provision approach is rationalized by stable activity trends and demand indicators that suggest amenities are reasonably well used but a significant shift in the overall level of supply is not needed. In other words, provision in alignment with growth is likely to be sufficient.

Table 15. Preliminary Sport Court Provision (Service Targets)

Increase the Provision Level	Sustain the Provision Level	Decrease the Provision Level

Court Type	Current Provision Level	Suggested Future Provision (Service Level) Relative to Current	Targeted for New Supply by 2035	Future Planning Considerations & Recommended Approaches
Tennis Courts	1: 11,810 residents (13 courts)		+2 – 4 courts	• Better understand site by site utilization and use this data to support surface and amenity renewal priorities. • Focus future court investment and management on providing casual and low barrier opportunities to the public, while supporting higher levels of play through partnerships and supports offered to external entities.

Court Type	Current Provision Level	Suggested Future Provision (Service Level) Relative to Current	Targeted for New Supply by 2035	Future Planning Considerations & Recommended Approaches
Pickleball Courts	1: 6,978 residents (22 courts) **Includes dedicated and mix use courts*		+8 courts	• In alignment with best practice, gradually shift away from providing multi-use court sites towards dedicated pickleball sites. This approach will better support tournaments, enable a progression of levels to play at the same site, and allow the City to optimally site pickleball courts. • Follow best practice guidance when siting and developing pickleball facilities to avoid noise and lighting disturbance. • Work with the pickleball community to track participation and growth trends. • Initiate planning for an additional 8+ court pickleball facility in the medium to long-term or alternative approaches such as a covered court facility that can accommodate pickleball along with other court activities.

Court Type	Current Provision Level	Suggested Future Provision (Service Level) Relative to Current	Targeted for New Supply by 2035	Future Planning Considerations & Recommended Approaches
Basketball Courts	1: 9,031 residents (17 courts)	↔	+2 – 4 courts	• Geographic distribution and access via active modes of transportation should be a key factor when planning for these court types • Wherever possible, site these courts adjacent to other recreation amenities to capitalize on support amenity synergies and existing transportation infrastructure. • Identify opportunities to create temporary court spaces in underutilized parking lots and other paved areas.
Sport Courts	1: 10,235 residents 15 courts)	↔	+2 – 4 courts	
Sand Volleyball Courts	1:51,173 residents	↔	***As per site context and opportunity analysis on an ongoing basis***	• Sand volleyball courts are a low-cost court type that can be easily added to existing and new park spaces (supply flexed as required). • Understanding current use and opportunities to integrate sand volleyball courts into existing and retrofitted park spaces should be explored on a case by case basis.

Court Type	Current Provision Level	Suggested Future Provision (Service Level) Relative to Current	Targeted for New Supply by 2035	Future Planning Considerations & Recommended Approaches
Multi-Use Covered Court Facility	N/A	*Further investigation required*	***Explore demand, benefits, costs, and potential uses***	• A variety of approaches could exist in providing a covered court facility – including an air supported structure, tensioned membrane (sprung structure), or covering of the existing lacrosse box. A covered structured could increase shoulder season and winter court capacity and provide space for other activities. • Further analysis of the costs, benefits potential uses, and structure typologies should be undertaken to inform future decision making.

Action C: Remain open to non-traditional and creative solutions to meeting sport court demands.

Sports courts are strong candidates for inclusion in underutilized community spaces such as parking lots, pocket parks, and future development areas given the relatively small footprint and ease of installation. Adding permanent or temporary court surfacing, nets, and providing equipment (balls, paddles, etc.) can help transform under-animated spaces and align with broader community planning objectives such as creating more activity in core areas and flexing court supply where geographic gaps may exist.

On a move forward basis, the City should remain open to creative ways to use sports courts as a mechanism to increase activity and vibrancy in underutilized urban spaces as well as increase access to casual sport and recreation opportunities in communities where walkable access may be more limited (see Figure 8 on page 41) or other factors may suggest a higher level of need (e.g. demographic factors, density, etc.). These tactics could include:

- Assessing small neighbourhood parks in the city that are underutilized and could be strong candidates for piloting temporary sport court surfaces and/or amenities.
- Integrating sport courts into underutilized parking lots and plazas in the downtown core.
- Considering sport court inclusions as part of broader civic infrastructure projects.
- Temporary sport court installations during the summer months in parking lots and other paved areas at City facilities.

Best Practice Example: Coopers Basketball Court (Vancouver, BC)

Coopers Basketball Court (Coopers Park) is located under the Cambie Street Bridge and over the years has transformed an underutilized urban space into a highly popular area for youth to play basketball. Other adjacent amenities include a playground and sitting, social spaces.

Photo Source: Vancouver Playgrounds

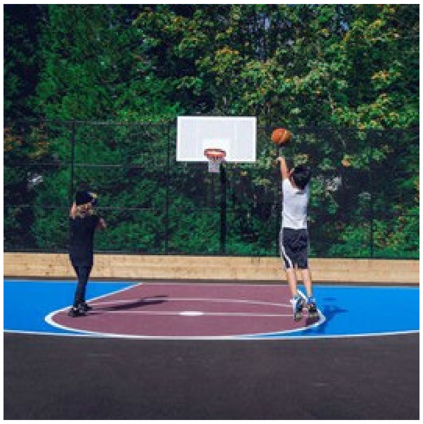
Best Practice Example: Vancouver Pop-Up Pickelball Courts

Over the past three years the Vancouver Park Board has piloted pop-up pickleball courts at underutilized courts across the city. These sites are non-bookable and intended to both provide introductory opportunities for new pickleball players and support overall demand for pickleball courts in the city.

Photo Source: CBC News

Best Practice Example: City of Coquitlam

The City of Coquitlam has placed a priority on creating colourful, dynamic, and inviting sport courts through renewal projects over the past decade. Examples include the retrofitted Brookmere Park and Burke Mountain Pioneer Park sites. Creating sites that are highly appealing can increase use, sense of place, and transform underutilized park space.



3.4. Draft Actions for Specialty Outdoor Sport Amenities

Summary of the Draft Actions for Specialty Outdoor Sport Amenities	
Draft Actions	**Draft Strategic Goals Achieved by the Action** **(See Section 2.2 for additional detail on each Goal)**
A. Support the growth of disc golf.	
B. Work with impacted users and activity groups to determine future options based on the direction of the Mill Lake Park Master Plan.	
C. Sustain the existing skateboard parks.	
D. Identify opportunities to support the growth of bike sports in Abbotsford and align with other future planning direction.	

Action A: Support the growth of disc golf.

Disc golf popularity continues to trend upwards, driven largely by the affordability, family friendly, and social aspects of the sport. Abbotsford does not currently provide a disc golf course, however the recently completed Mill Lake Park Master Plan has identified the development of a 9-hole course as a recommended Phase 1 item. This amenity addition will support recreational disc golf and introductory level participation.

In addition to the proposed Mill Lake Park course, it is recommended that the City explore and identify additional sites that could accommodate a future 18-hole disc golf course. The rationale for expanding the provision of disc golf in Abbotsford includes:

- Affordability of the activity
- Regional and provincial trends and demand indicators
- Potential economic benefits (non-local visitation and spending)
- Risk profile (disc golf infrastructure has a minimal cost relative to other facilities/ amenities and can easily be removed within park sites if the activity decreases in popularity)

Key Indicators on the Growth of Disc Golf **_*Data from UDisc (www.udisc.com)_**

- Canada has the third most disc golf courses in the world (871).
- 87% of players worldwide travel 32 km for a round of disc golf.
- 86% of disc golfers introduced someone else to the sport.
- In 2024, Raptors Knoll Disc Golf Park in Langley recorded the most rounds (23,214) in British Columbia and was second among all Canadian courses.
- There are 185-disc golf courses in British Columbia, 97 of which feature 18 holes.
- Across British Columbia in 2024 there were 295,000 rounds recorded by 46,909 users for an estimated total of 455,000 recreational hours.
- BC is home to 168 active UDisc leagues and hosted 2,185 events in 2024.

Action B: Work with impacted users and activity groups to determine future options based on the direction of the Mill Lake Park Master Plan.

The Mill Lake Park Master Plan proposes to re-locate the horseshoe pits to a new location within the park, which will continue to support use by the Abbotsford Horseshoe Club and general public.

The plan recommends the relocation of the lawn bowling facility off-site as well as the removal of the north ball diamond. The north diamond accommodates a range of approximately 250 – 450 hours of annual use that will need to be accommodated at existing or new diamonds in the city. The addition of 3-4 new Class A ball diamonds, upgrades to existing diamonds, and the development of a potential new sports park as recommended in the Section 3.2 actions should offset the loss of this diamond. The lawn bowling facility currently at Mill Lake is the only such facility in the city and a decision will need to be made on the best move forward option to support lawn bowling.

The City could look to identify existing sport field or sport court sites that are strong candidates for retrofit to a lawn bowling green based on the following key criteria:

- Minimal impact on existing users (e.g. site that is currently underutilized)
- Site characteristics that will enable a lawn bowling green to be installed in a relatively cost efficient manner (e.g. irrigation, soil conditions, and grading are suitable).
- Existing support infrastructure and/or the ability to add a temporary building structure.
- Site and amenity conditions that balance providing a suitable home for lawn bowling while also having the ability to be retrofitted for other uses in the future if participation declines.

As part of the above steps, the City should also continue engaging with the Lawn Bowling Club to ensure clarity on resourcing, future site management responsibilities, and long-term plan to sustain the sport.

Action C: Sustain the existing skateboard parks.

The City currently operates two skateboard parks – McMillan Youth Park (approximately 25,000 sq. ft.) and a smaller hybrid location between W. J. Mouat High School and Colleen and Gordie Howe Middle School (approximately 7,000 sq. ft.). McMillan Youth Park is destination level skate site that supports a range of progressive skill levels and styles of skateboarding. The Park is primarily used in an unstructured manner but does host some booked events and competitions. The City has recently also re-surfaced the skateboard infrastructure which included the addition of new amenities.

Community engagement, benchmarking, and assessment of the two current facilities suggest that the city is currently adequately supplied with skateboard infrastructure for at least the medium term. The improved collection of utilization data and trends monitoring can help inform a future review of skateboard park needs.

Action D: Identify opportunities to support the growth of bike sports in Abbotsford and align with other future planning direction.

The BMX Track is located at Exhibition Park and supports a mix of casual and programmed use – hours booked by Cycling Canada's BMX National Team and the Abbotsford BMX Society have ranged from approximately 400 – 1,000 hours over the past five years. The track is also assessed to be in good condition. The City should continue to support the track, including the consideration of funding requests for capital repairs and upgrades.

Mountain biking is continuing to surge in popularity, especially in British Columbia. This growth is being driven by several factors, including:

- Overall demand for moderately to aggressive intensity nature based sport and recreation.
- E-bikes
- Provincial, regional, and local jurisdiction investment to grow tourism and visitor economies

In addition to having a good trail network in the city that supports mountain biking, Abbotsford is also located at the western edge of a highly popular mountain biking corridor that extends out into the eastern areas of the Fraser Valley and beyond. These geographic factors are likely to result in continued demand for mountain bike opportunities in the city and surrounding areas. The benefits of investing in mountain bike infrastructure include:

- Directing mountain biking to trails and spaces where it is ideally suited and away from areas that it is not (e.g. trails with potential conflicting uses, sensitive ecological areas, etc.).
- Opportunity to capitalize on economic benefits through increased non-local spending.
- Supporting a trending activity that is multi-generational.
- Increasing the diversity of sport and recreation opportunities for residents.

Recently, the City also approved the inclusion of pump tracks in the park amenities program which provides an additional mechanisms to support bike sports. **More specific direction on future needs, priorities, and approaches for bike infrastructure will be provided in the City's Trail and Off-Road Cycling Strategy.**

Best Practice Example: Penzer Park (Langley, BC)

Penzer Park in Langley encompasses a bike skills park and pump track as well as several adjacent and complementary non-bike sports amenities (parkour course and sport court). The park site is located in a utility corridor and provides a unique regional bike sports attraction.

Photos Source: Skateparktour.ca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